Zulafqar Ali

Principal Software Engineer | PHP · Laravel · Microservices · AWS

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Open to Remote Roles 9+ Years of Experience Nationality: Pakistani
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Software Engineer with **9+ years** of experience building and scaling backend systems in PHP (Laravel, Symfony, Yii2). Delivered **microservices platforms on AWS serving millions of users**, SuiteCRM solutions for healthcare recruitment with AI-assisted screening and job matching, and real-time QuickBooks synchronization for tax and accounting workflows. Strong in requirements analysis, solution design, REST API development, CI/CD, production debugging, code review and mentoring. Has **led teams of 4 to 6 engineers** and collaborated in cross-functional teams of up to 40. Seeking remote Principal / Senior backend engineering roles.

9+ Years	Millions	7,000+	4 – 6
Backend engineering in PHP	Users on platforms delivered (80+ branches)	CRM users, healthcare recruitment platform	Engineers led per project, on schedule

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineer
Dec 2022 – Present

Tkxel · Lahore, Pakistan

- Built backend services on a **Laravel microservices architecture on AWS** powering online ordering across 80+ restaurant branches and millions of users — custom item preparation, loyalty programs, kitchen-to-customer order status updates, payment gateway integrations and delivery workflows.
- Set up **AWS CI/CD deployment pipelines** for automated releases; debugged and resolved production issues on the live system.
- Building a **SuiteCRM healthcare recruitment platform** for 7,000+ CRM users with AI-assisted candidate assessments, resume screening, survey generation and profile-to-job matching.
- Defined solution architecture from client requirements and implemented **eDocs**, a document digitization and e-signature application (team of 12).
- Analyzed client requirements and translated them into technical solutions within a **40-engineer cross-functional team**.
- Mentor junior developers, conduct code reviews and enforce coding standards.

Senior Software Engineer
Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

CarSwitch · Lahore, Pakistan

- Translated product-team requirements into technical solutions, breaking down tasks and estimating effort, and delivered application features on time using **PHP and Yii2**.
- Diagnosed and resolved complex design and technical issues; provided technical support for clients across local and global sites.
- Delivered internal tech sessions to the engineering team.

Senior Software Engineer
Jan 2020 – Jan 2022

Rolustech · Lahore, Pakistan

- Customized SuiteCRM into **ttgat.us**, a tax audit and accounting platform covering business audits, invoicing, payments and work-progress tracking for **200+ CRM users**.
- Re-engineered data-processing and accounting-book workflows handling roughly **50 GB of financial data**, and built **real-time, two-way synchronization** with QuickBooks Online.
- Automated manual insurance and device-repair processes in **Xension**, a custom CRM with role-based access and task assignment for hundreds of users, supporting millions of requests.
- Led teams of **4 to 6 engineers and QAs** across multiple projects, running daily scrums and bi-weekly sprints and shipping on schedule.

Software Engineer
Mar 2017 – Dec 2019

Rolustech · Lahore, Pakistan

- Worked with development and QA teams to design and build solutions meeting client requirements for **functionality, scalability and performance**.
- Identified and resolved complex design and technical issues across projects; provided end-user support to clients on local and global sites.

Web Developer
Jul 2014 – Jan 2017

EGlobal Solution · Lahore, Pakistan

- Converted design mockups into working websites using **HTML, JavaScript, AJAX and JSON**.
- Planned and implemented website changes and integrations to streamline client business operations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI-Assisted Dev	GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, JetBrains AI Assistant, ChatGPT Codex, OpenCode, Cursor; Context Writing & Memory Management, Agents & Skill Creation, Prompt Writing & Engineering
Backend	PHP, Laravel, Symfony, Yii2, CodeIgniter, Zend; REST APIs, JSON, Microservices, OOP, MVC, Design Patterns; Python (working knowledge)
JavaScript Stack	JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js, jQuery, AJAX, HTML5, CSS3, Vue.js, AngularJS
Databases & Caching	MySQL, AWS Aurora, Redis, MS SQL, SQLite
Cloud & DevOps	AWS (Aurora, CI/CD pipelines), Docker, GitLab CI/CD, Git, GitHub, Bitbucket
CRM & Integrations	SuiteCRM, SugarCRM, QuickBooks Online API & PHP SDK, Payment gateways, Third-party APIs
Practices & Tools	Agile/Scrum, Sprint Planning, Code Review, Requirements Analysis, Solution Design, Technical Mentoring; Jira, Teamwork, Trello, Redmine, PHPStorm

INDUSTRY DOMAINS

Online Ordering & Food Delivery · Healthcare Recruitment · Tax & Accounting · Document Digitization & E-Signature · Insurance & Device Repair · Automotive Marketplace · CRM Platforms

CERTIFICATIONS

- SugarCRM Developer Certification

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science 2016

The University of Lahore, Pakistan

> **Open to Remote:** Based in Lahore, Pakistan (UTC+5) — available for remote principal and senior backend roles.

LANGUAGES

English — Professional Working Proficiency **Urdu** — Native